UNIVERSAL TOKEN SYSTEM · PHASE 1

What you see is what it means.

Self-describing colour tokens for the categorical layer — same pixels, clearer names, no magic.

The categorical vocabulary, by role.

cat-N-fill

Background. The pale categorical surface a band sits on (was `--cN-light`).

cat-N-mark

Foreground. The saturated stroke, mark, or cScale feed (was `--cN-dark`).

cat-on-fill

Foreground. Ink for text placed on a fill (was `--c-ink-light`).

cat-on-mark

Foreground. Ink for text placed on a mark (was `--c-ink-dark`).

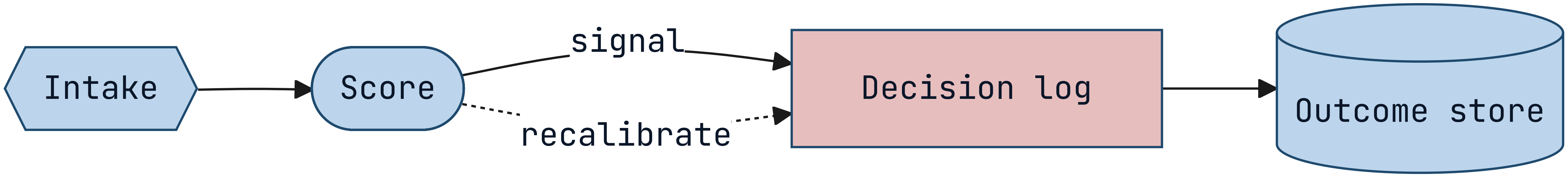
Foreground or background — never ambiguous.

The pairing law

A background takes the bare role name; a foreground names the background it reads against with `on-`. Colour-scheme lives only inside the `light-dark()` value, never in a token name.

01 · FLOWCHART

Band fills and strokes resolve through the new names.

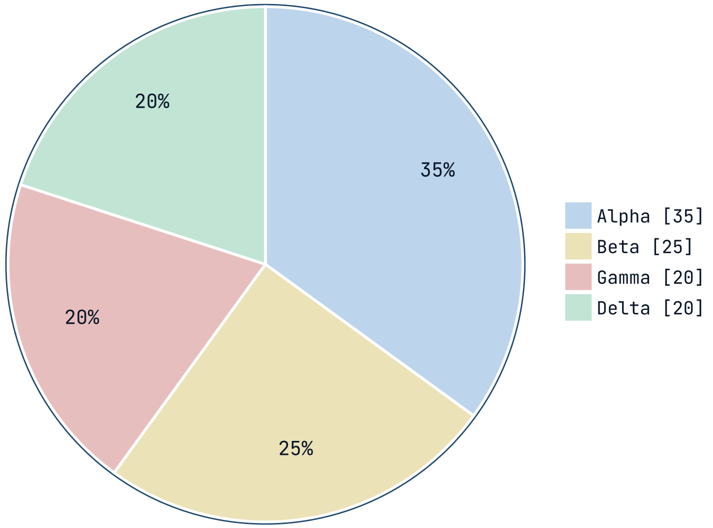


KEY INSIGHT

Node fills read `--cat-1-fill`; borders read the structural stroke — both painted via the upgraded offline bridge.

02 · PIE

Categorical marks across the cycle.

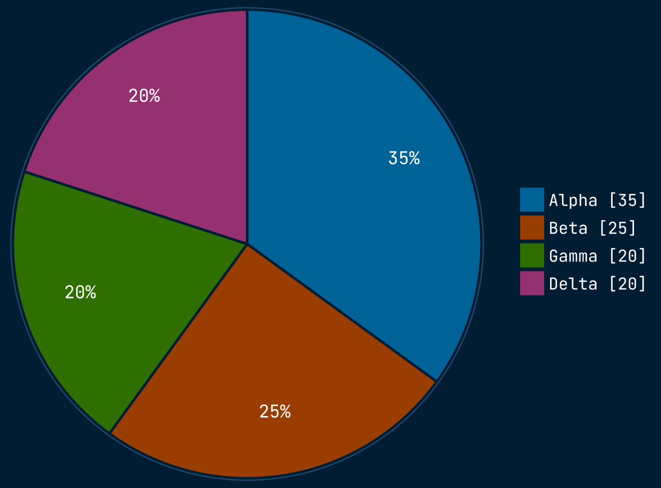


KEY INSIGHT

Wedges cycle `--cat-1-mark` … `--cat-4-mark`; the percentage labels read `--cat-on-fill`.

03 · PIE, DARK CANVAS

The same names, dark branch.

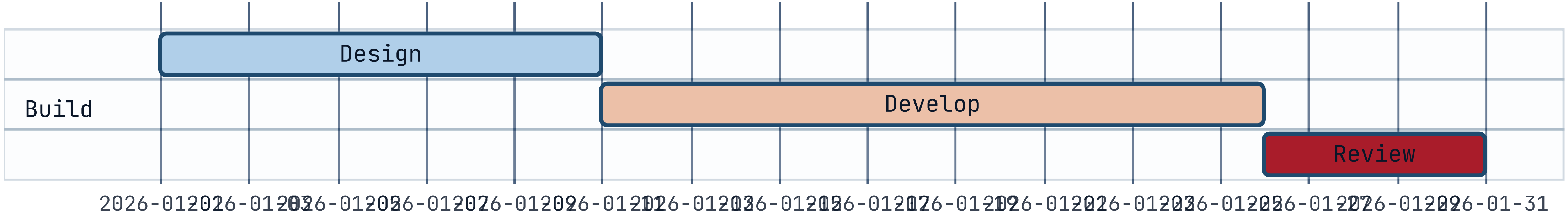


KEY INSIGHT

One token, both schemes: `light-dark()` inside each `--cat-*` value resolves to the dark branch here — proof the new names carry the scheme, not the name.

04 · GANTT

Categorical fills and semantic states, side by side.



KEY INSIGHT

Task fills read `--cat-1-fill`; done / active / crit read the semantic states (a separate group, unchanged this phase).

PHASE 1 OF 7 · SEE ENGINEERING/DECISIONS/2026-06-11-UNIVERSAL-TOKEN-SYSTEM.MD

Byte-identical today; scalable tomorrow.